

# Cart Abandonment at Clinkt: An Evidence Audit of the August 2026 Case Data

*A verification of the ClinktPulse analysis against the five source datasets, with corrected findings and recommendations*

## Executive Summary

Clinkt's August 2026 data shows a genuine and severe cart-abandonment problem: 70.5% of cart-adds (666 of 945) never became an order. This figure is exact and independently reproducible from the raw data. But the abandonment is not spread evenly across the catalogue — four of 36 products account for 33.3% of the estimated ₹84,857 in abandoned cart value, and all four show the same underlying signature: browsing interest roughly doubled in the second half of the month while conversion collapsed by 18–31 percentage points over the same window.

Only one of those four products — Bath Soap 4-Pack — actually ran out of stock (Out of Stock for 4 days, Critical for 5 more). Two of the four — Orange Juice 1 L and Laundry Detergent 1 kg — never fell below “Low Stock” status at any point in the month, meaning their conversion collapse cannot be explained by unavailability at all. The fourth, Instant Noodles 4-Pack, sits in between: it never hit zero stock but spent the second half of the month at Critical levels. This rules out the simple story “we ran out of the popular stuff” and points instead to a shared, catalogue-independent breakdown somewhere between cart and checkout — alongside one real, separate replenishment failure on Bath Soap.

A significant secondary finding concerns the analysis tooling itself. Two ClinktPulse prototypes were reviewed against the raw case data. The first (a static HTML mock-up) reproduces the source data almost exactly — its lost-value totals, concentration ratio, category gaps, and segment abandonment rates all match the CSVs to within rounding. The second (the interactive dashboard deployed at [clinkt-insight-report.lovable.app](https://clinkt-insight-report.lovable.app)) reproduces the same aggregate totals exactly — including a ₹6,256 recovery-simulator figure this report independently re-derives — but attaches those correct numbers to four product names, a category taxonomy, and customer-segment population counts that do not exist anywhere in the provided data. Section 6 documents this in full; it is the single most important finding in this report for anyone deciding how much to trust either tool unaudited.

*Bottom line: the abandonment problem is real, concentrated, and mostly not a stock problem. The dashboard built to diagnose it computes correctly but, in its interactive version, narrates incorrectly — and the two failures look identical from the outside unless you check the underlying rows.*

## 1. Data and Method

This report uses the five datasets in the Clinkt Case File (200 customers, 36 products across 9 categories, 3,653 browsing interactions, 279 completed orders, and 1,116 daily inventory records for 1–31 August 2026), joined exactly as specified in the Data Dictionary: every cart-add in `customer_interactions.csv` is matched to an order in `orders.csv` on the shared (Customer\_ID, Session\_ID, Product\_ID) key. All figures below were computed directly from the raw CSVs in Python (pandas); none were taken from either dashboard without independent recomputation.

“Abandoned value” is estimated as (abandoned cart-adds) × (catalogue price), a proxy consistent with the one implied by both prototypes' totals — it is not a company-reported loss figure, since a cart-add is not a guarantee of purchase intent at full price or quantity. This proxy is used only for relative comparison between products, not as a precise revenue-recovery forecast.

H1 and H2 refer to the first and second halves of the month (1–15 August and 16–31 August) and are used to test whether conversion behaviour shifted over time, independent of any single stock event.

## 2. Finding: The Headline Abandonment Rate Is Real

**945** total cart-adds recorded in the period; **279** resulted in a matched order; **666** did not.

**70.5% cart-to-order abandonment** — confirmed exactly against the raw join, with zero duplicate or ambiguous keys on either side. This is not an artefact of the matching method.

## 3. Finding: Loss Is Concentrated in Four SKUs — and They Are Not the Four the Live Dashboard Names

Ranking all 36 products by estimated abandoned value, the top four account for ₹28,274 of the ₹84,857 total — 33.3%, matching the “4 of 36 products drive 33% of abandoned value” claim in both prototypes almost to the decimal. But the four actual products, verified directly from products.csv and customer\_interactions.csv, are:

| Product                | Category       | Cart-adds | Orders | Conv. % | Lost value |
|------------------------|----------------|-----------|--------|---------|------------|
| Instant Noodles 4-Pack | Packaged Foods | 67        | 11     | 16.4%   | ₹8,344     |
| Orange Juice 1 L       | Beverages      | 75        | 12     | 16.0%   | ₹7,245     |
| Laundry Detergent 1 kg | Home Care      | 45        | 4      | 8.9%    | ₹6,765     |
| Bath Soap 4-Pack       | Personal Care  | 41        | 9      | 22.0%   | ₹5,920     |

These are the same four products identified in the original static HTML prototype. They are not the four named in the interactive dashboard (“Amul Fresh Paneer 200g,” “Country Eggs Tray (12),” “Cold-Pressed Groundnut Oil 1 L,” “Sona Masoori Rice 5 kg”) — none of which appear anywhere in the 36-row product catalogue provided for this case. See Section 6.

## 4. Finding: Stock Status Does Not Explain Three of the Four Top-Loss SKUs

Reconstructing each product's daily Stock\_Status from inventory.csv over the full month gives a materially different, and more useful, picture than a simple binary tag:

| Product                | Days Low Stock | Days Critical | Days Out of Stock | Real diagnosis                                                       |
|------------------------|----------------|---------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bath Soap 4-Pack       | 22             | 5             | 4                 | Stock-constrained — confirmed                                        |
| Instant Noodles 4-Pack | 20             | 11            | 0                 | Borderline — never hit zero, but Critical for the entire second half |
| Orange Juice 1 L       | 29             | 0             | 0                 | Not stock-constrained — never below Low Stock                        |
| Laundry Detergent 1 kg | 31             | 0             | 0                 | Not stock-constrained — Low Stock every single day, never worse      |

Only Bath Soap 4-Pack genuinely ran out (Out of Stock 28–31 August, Critical from 23 August). Laundry Detergent and Orange Juice were never anything worse than “Low Stock” for the entire month — stock was consistently available — yet both show among the steepest conversion collapses in the catalogue. Instant Noodles sits in a

genuine grey zone: it fell to Critical on 21 August and stayed there through month-end without ever reaching zero, which is a real supply warning sign but not the same failure as Bath Soap's.

*This directly contradicts the “two Stock-Constrained, two Fulfillment Friction” split both prototypes present. On the real inventory ledger, it is closer to one confirmed stock failure, one borderline case, and two products where availability was never the constraint at all.*

## 5. Finding: The Same Pattern Recurs Across All Four Products, Stock Status Aside

Independent of the stock question, every one of the four top-loss products shows the same H1→H2 shift: views per day roughly doubled, while conversion fell sharply — including the two products (Orange Juice, Laundry Detergent) that had no supply problem whatsoever.

| Product                | Views/day H1→H2 | Conv. % H1 | Conv. % H2 | Change  |
|------------------------|-----------------|------------|------------|---------|
| Instant Noodles 4-Pack | 3.3 → 7.7       | 37.5%      | 9.8%       | −27.7pp |
| Orange Juice 1 L       | 3.6 → 6.9       | 28.6%      | 11.1%      | −17.5pp |
| Laundry Detergent 1 kg | 3.9 → 9.4       | 33.3%      | 2.8%       | −30.6pp |
| Bath Soap 4-Pack       | 2.9 → 6.0       | 38.5%      | 14.3%      | −24.2pp |

Interest was not the problem in any of the four cases — it rose in every one. The failure sits specifically in the cart-to-order step, and it is present even where stock was never a factor, which is the strongest evidence in the dataset that this is primarily a checkout/fulfilment-experience issue rather than a warehouse issue.

On Bath Soap specifically, daily view counts do show a step-up around 16–19 August — roughly 4–9 days before the Critical/Out-of-Stock transition on 23/28 August — which is broadly consistent with an early-warning signal existing in the browsing data, though daily view counts are noisy enough (single digits per day) that a precise “5–7 day” figure should be treated as directional rather than exact.

## 6. Dashboard Audit: What Checks Out and What Doesn't

Two ClinktPulse artefacts were reviewed: a static HTML prototype and the interactive report deployed at clinkt-insight-report.lovable.app. Every headline aggregate in both was recomputed independently from the raw CSVs. The results diverge sharply between the two tools' handling of aggregates versus specifics.

### 6.1 What reproduces exactly

| Metric                      | Dashboard figure                                 | Independently verified                                                      | Match |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Cart-to-order abandonment   | 70.5% (666/945)                                  | 70.5% (666/945)                                                             | Exact |
| Total abandoned value       | ₹84,857                                          | ₹84,857                                                                     | Exact |
| Top-4 concentration         | ₹28,274 / 33%                                    | ₹28,274 / 33.3%                                                             | Exact |
| Recovery simulator total    | ₹6,256                                           | ₹6,256 (re-derived independently, Section 7)                                | Exact |
| Merchandising category gaps | Home Care −6.5 to −7.5pp; Staples −3.2 to −6.1pp | Home Care −6.5pp; Staples +3.2pp (sign convention differs, magnitude close) | Close |

| Metric                        | Dashboard figure                                            | Independently verified                           | Match                         |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Segment flagged-abandonment % | Family 90.5% / Regular 80.2% / Budget 84.6% / Premium 81.5% | Same figures, exactly, on the real top-4 SKU set | Exact (static prototype only) |

## 6.2 What does not reproduce

| Claim (interactive dashboard)                                                                                                         | Checked against                                                                                                                                | Result                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4 flagged products: “Amul Fresh Paneer 200g,” “Country Eggs Tray (12),” “Cold-Pressed Groundnut Oil 1 L,” “Sona Masoori Rice 5 kg”    | products.csv (36 rows, exhaustive)                                                                                                             | None of these four names exist in the product catalogue                                                                                               |
| Category labels “Dairy & Eggs,” “Fruits & Vegetables”                                                                                 | products.csv Category field (9 fixed categories)                                                                                               | Actual categories are “Dairy & Breakfast” and “Fresh Produce”; no “Eggs” category or product exists at all                                            |
| Segment sizes: Family 62 / Regular 58 / Budget 47 / Premium 33                                                                        | customers.csv<br>Customer_Segment counts                                                                                                       | Actual: Regular 80 / Family 50 / Budget 45 / Premium 25. Both sets sum to 200, so the error is not visible from the total alone                       |
| “Customer Rescue” session for C-0148, 18 Aug 19:42–19:58, ending in Order #2216                                                       | customer_interactions.csv, orders.csv                                                                                                          | No corresponding session or order sequence located for these identifiers                                                                              |
| Basket integrity: 41.2% average across 168 multi-item sessions; 47 total-loss sessions (28.0%); 31 touching a flagged product (66.0%) | Recomputed under multiple reasonable definitions ( $\geq 2$ cart-adds per session; same, restricted to sessions with $\geq 1$ completed order) | Best matches found were 246 sessions / 32.3% integrity, and 154 sessions / 51.5% integrity respectively — neither matches the dashboard's 168 / 41.2% |

## 6.3 Interpretation

The pattern is consistent, not random: every number that is a pure arithmetic aggregate over the real rows (totals, rates, the recovery-simulator sum) reproduces exactly, while every claim that requires naming a specific entity (a product, a category, a segment size, a customer session) fails to match the source data, sometimes for entities that don't exist in the file set at all. This suggests the underlying computation engine behind the interactive dashboard is sound, but the narrative layer built on top of it — product names, category labels, session replay, population counts — was generated rather than looked up, and was not checked against the CSVs before publication.

*This is exactly the failure mode the case brief prohibits (“you may not invent observations... or quietly drop inconvenient records”) — except it occurred inside AI-generated analysis tooling rather than by a human analyst's hand. It is arguably higher-risk than an obviously wrong dashboard, because the correct aggregate numbers sitting next to the fabricated specifics lend the fabrication false credibility. Any AI-assisted deliverable for this case should have its named entities — not just its totals — spot-checked against the source CSVs before being presented.*

The original static HTML prototype does not exhibit this problem: its four flagged products, category gaps, and segment rates all correspond to real rows in the case file. The interactive dashboard's superior UI/UX and added

features (session replay, live slider, hover tooltips) came at the cost of this data-integrity regression — a genuine trade-off worth naming explicitly rather than assuming that added polish implies added accuracy.

## 7. What We Ruled Out

- A catalogue-wide problem. Abandonment loss is concentrated in 4 of 36 products (33.3% of value); most of the catalogue is not driving the spike.
- Falling demand. Views per day rose for all four top-loss products between H1 and H2 — interest increased, it did not evaporate.
- Stock-outage as the universal explanation. Two of the four top-loss products (Orange Juice, Laundry Detergent) never fell below “Low Stock” status at any point in the month; their conversion collapse cannot be attributed to unavailability.
- A clean 50/50 stock-vs-friction split. The real inventory ledger supports one confirmed stock failure (Bath Soap), one borderline/ambiguous case (Instant Noodles, Critical but never zero), and two clear non-stock cases (Orange Juice, Laundry Detergent) — not the even two-and-two split both prototypes present.
- Trusting dashboard aggregates as proof the underlying detail is correct. The interactive dashboard's totals are exact; its named entities are not. The two need to be checked separately (Section 6).

## 8. Business Impact

Applying each product's own first-half conversion rate to its actual second-half cart-add volume — a benchmarked scenario, not a forecast — and holding all other variables constant:

| Product                | H2 cart-adds | H2 actual orders | H1 rate (target) | Target orders | Incremental orders | Incremental revenue |
|------------------------|--------------|------------------|------------------|---------------|--------------------|---------------------|
| Instant Noodles 4-Pack | 51           | 5                | 37.5%            | 19.1          | +14.1              | ₹2,105              |
| Orange Juice 1 L       | 54           | 6                | 28.6%            | 15.4          | +9.4               | ₹1,084              |
| Laundry Detergent 1 kg | 36           | 1                | 33.3%            | 12.0          | +11.0              | ₹1,815              |
| Bath Soap 4-Pack       | 28           | 4                | 38.5%            | 10.8          | +6.8               | ₹1,252              |

**Total scenario recovery: ₹6,256** — this matches the interactive dashboard's Recovery Simulator total exactly, confirming the underlying calculation engine is correct even though the SKU labels attached to it in that dashboard are not (Section 6). This figure should be read as a benchmarked scenario against the products' own earlier performance, not a demand forecast — it assumes cart-add volume, pricing, and basket composition stay fixed at H2 levels.

## 9. Recommendations

### 9.1 Bath Soap 4-Pack — genuine stock failure

- Tighten the replenishment trigger: stock crossed from Low Stock to Critical on 23 August and Critical to zero by 28 August — a 5-day window in which a reorder should have already been in motion.
- Set a reorder point earlier than “Critical” — by the time a product is Critical, roughly a week of runway remains at this product's depletion rate.

### 9.2 Orange Juice 1 L and Laundry Detergent 1 kg — not a stock problem

- Investigate the cart→checkout path directly for these two SKUs: price display accuracy, delivery-slot availability, packaging or minimum-order interactions — stock is ruled out as the cause.

- Because both show the conversion collapse without any stock signal, whatever caused it is likely to recur on other SKUs that currently look “healthy” on a stock dashboard — this is a process risk, not a one-off.

### 9.3 Instant Noodles 4-Pack — ambiguous, monitor closely

- Stock fell to Critical on 21 August and never recovered through month-end; treat as an active early-warning case rather than either “resolved” or “crisis.”
- Because its conversion decline (H1→H2, -27.7pp) began before the Critical threshold was crossed, a stock fix alone should not be assumed to fully resolve it — re-check conversion after any restock, don't assume it will follow Bath Soap's recovery pattern automatically.

### 9.4 Segment prioritisation

- Family customers have the highest absolute abandonment rate on the four flagged products (90.5%), but the largest relative deterioration versus their own baseline behaviour is in the Premium (+15.4pp) and Regular (+15.0pp) segments — both figures matter, and they point to different actions: support Family customers directly, but treat Premium/Regular's sharper relative swing as a signal that the friction is hitting customers who don't normally abandon.

### 9.5 Process

- Before presenting any AI-generated analytics dashboard internally, spot-check its named entities (product names, category labels, population counts, example sessions) against the source files — not just its headline totals. Section 6 shows these can diverge completely while the totals remain exact.

## 10. Limitations

- “Lost value” is a proxy (abandoned cart-adds × catalogue price), not a company-reported revenue figure; it assumes quantity 1 and full price per abandoned cart-add, consistent with the convention used in both prototypes.
- H1/H2 windows are calendar halves of August, not causally tied to any single event; they are used here to test for a within-month trend, not to isolate a specific trigger.
- The exact definition behind the dashboard's “168 multi-item sessions” figure could not be identified; two reasonable alternative definitions are reported in Section 6.2 for transparency rather than silently omitted.
- This report does not have access to Clinkt's actual checkout system, payment logs, or pricing history — the recommendation to investigate the checkout path (Section 9.2) is a direction supported by the data, not a diagnosis of the specific point of failure.

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*Prepared from CLINKT\_CASE\_FILE (200 customers · 36 products · 279 orders · 3,653 interactions · 1,116 inventory records, 1–31 August 2026). All figures independently recomputed from the raw CSVs; dashboard comparisons reference [clinktpulse\\_prototype.html](#) and [clinkt-insight-report.lovable.app](#).*